

Philipp Hilbert. *First PM hire, data-integration products.*

Positioning, 13 years shipping SaaS products from zero teaches you what to cut first, and Windsor's 300-integration pressure is exactly the problem I have solved before.

BERLIN, GERMANY · HILBERT@TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN · [TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN](https://true-north.berlin)

[LinkedIn](#) · [GitHub](#) · www.true-north.berlin · [YouTube \(EN sample\)](#)

Dear Windsor.ai team,

Windsor's core promise is simple to state and hard to execute: marketing data from 300+ sources, delivered clean to 30+ destinations, for 6,000+ customers who cannot afford pipeline failures. The product challenge that interests me is not the integration count, it is the prioritisation discipline required to keep that system trustworthy when every customer and sales call arrives with a new "just one more" request. You described it exactly right in the posting: the job is cutting the list down, not growing it blindly.

I have spent 13 years shipping SaaS products in environments where the backlog pressure was real and the engineering capacity was finite. At the Bundesagentur für Arbeit I owned a national labour-market analytics platform: I cut the data-update pipeline from a hand-held quarterly process to an automated Dagster and dbt flow, saving 75% of update time, and I did it by being willing to say no to the features that looked useful but would not survive the next data-structure change. At CLINET Platforms I inherited a roadmap a five-person team could not deliver; I reduced it to the top 10% of features against agreed success measures, and user acceptance rose more than fivefold. These are not process anecdotes, they are the same decision muscle Windsor needs on its integration backlog.

The data integration and ETL domain is not new territory for me. I have owned ETL pipelines, modelled data with dbt, run Dagster orchestrations, and worked directly in PostgreSQL for funnel and retention analysis without routing requests through an analyst. I understand what an API integration costs to maintain over time, and I have enough engineering fluency, Kubernetes, Docker, CI/CD, GitOps, to give estimates that engineers do not have to correct at standup.

Windsor is also the first PM hire, which means building the function, not inheriting one. I have done that twice: at Qcrypt AG I owned product from nothing through enterprise sales cycles, and at construct8 I built a two-sided marketplace solo from zero using LLM agents across the funnel. I know what the first ninety days look like when there is no roadmap to plug into, and I know that the first deliverable is a prioritisation framework the team trusts, not a Confluence page nobody reads.

The async, distributed-Europe way of working is how I have operated for four years. I do not need daily standups to stay unblocked, and I do not mistake activity for progress.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*
